REFERENCIA DE LEYENDAS · v0.2

El Mall Vivo

Legends and game mechanics · starting reference

The legends selected for the game, what each one says,
and the mechanic it becomes.

Prepared for Augusto · October 2026

How to use this reference

Each card below is a legend selected for the game: what the legend says, and the mechanic it becomes. Priority marks when to build it: **Vertical slice** for the first playable area, **Core** for the main game, and **Later** for polish and extra content.

#	Legend	Area	Priority
1	The mall is alive	Everywhere	Core
2	The labyrinth and the moving exit	Atriums, upper floors	Core
3	The wrong-floor elevator	Elevators	Vertical slice
4	Lost in the parking garage	Parking garage (procedural)	Vertical slice
5	The abandoned cars	Parking garage	Vertical slice
6	Screams in the parking garage	Parking garage	Core
7	Night noises in the food court	Food court	Vertical slice
8	The abandoned gym	Gym	Core
9	The secret gray corridors	Service corridors	Core
10	The offices with swimming pools	Upper-floor offices	Later
11	The TV station offices	TV station offices	Later
12	The shadow on the cameras	Security room, parking garage	Core
13	The girl in white	Bathrooms, elevators	Core
14	The watchers	Food court, hallways, atriums	Core
15	The origin of the mall	Notes throughout	Core
16	The weapons in the ceiling	Fifth floor	Later
17	The laughing-drug photo	Any shop	Later

Naming convention: real businesses and people connected to these legends get fictional names in the game, including a lightly fictionalized name for the mall itself.

The mall itself

1. The mall is alive

Area: Everywhere · Core

El mall está vivo

THE LEGEND

The building has absorbed so much tragedy that it became a kind of living thing. It changes the number of floors, moves its exits, and shows each visitor something different. What people see from outside is only its shell.

GAME MECHANIC

The game's central premise and true antagonist. The mall rearranges itself around the player: doors that were open are now closed, corridors loop back on themselves, and areas change between visits. Every other threat is one of its manifestations. The higher the player's fear, the more the mall shifts.

NOTES

This legend justifies every unusual mechanic in the game, so the story stays coherent.

2. The labyrinth and the moving exit

Area: Atriums, upper floors · Core

La sensación de laberinto

THE LEGEND

Visitors feel lost and can't find their way out. Some could see the exit from an upper floor, but once they went down it was gone. Some needed security guards to help them leave as closing time approached.

GAME MECHANIC

A recurring goal the player can never quite reach: the main exit is visible from the atrium railings, but the route down always leads somewhere else. Reaching it is the game's final objective, possible only once the player understands the mall.

3. The wrong-floor elevator

Area: Elevators · Vertical slice

El ascensor que lleva a otro piso

THE LEGEND

People choose a floor in the elevator and arrive somewhere completely different. The rumor is strongest around the parking floors, where people spent hours trying to reach the level where they parked.

GAME MECHANIC

Elevators are unreliable: the floor shown on the display doesn't always match where the doors open. This is how the player first enters the procedural parking garage. Low sanity makes wrong floors more likely.

Places

4. Lost in the parking garage

Area: Parking garage (procedural) · Vertical slice

Perdidos en los parqueos

THE LEGEND

People supposedly went missing in the parking levels. Their last sighting was on the security cameras there, and then they simply vanished, as if they had crossed into another place.

GAME MECHANIC

The procedural garage section, built from the chunk generator. It looks normal at first, then level signs skip (P2, P3, P7, P-12) and “Salida” arrows point into walls. Goal: reach a payphone, intercom, or attendant booth before sanity runs out. Failing means waking up somewhere else in the mall.

NOTES

Missing-person posters on garage columns can tell the stories of those who never came back.

5. The abandoned cars

Area: Parking garage · Vertical slice

Los carros abandonados

THE LEGEND

Cars left in the same parking spot for days or much longer, never claimed or towed. The best known is an abandoned minivan locals nicknamed after a cartoon mystery van.

GAME MECHANIC

A recurring landmark: the same van keeps reappearing in the procedural garage, telling the player they are going in circles. Some abandoned cars can be used as hiding spots.

NOTES

Use a generic van, not the cartoon's design.

6. Screams in the parking garage

Area: Parking garage · Core

Los gritos en los parqueos

THE LEGEND

People report hearing screams in the parking levels, especially at night.

GAME MECHANIC

Directional audio events. A scream may point toward the way out or lure the player deeper into the garage, and the player never knows which.

7. Night noises in the food court

Area: Food court · Vertical slice

Ruidos nocturnos en el food court

THE LEGEND

Guards and night staff hear tables moving, objects falling, and footsteps in the food court after closing, even when they are alone.

GAME MECHANIC

The first area of the game. Physics events trigger when the player isn't looking: chairs shift, trays fall, footsteps cross the hall. It teaches the player to use sound and establishes that the mall is not empty.

8. The abandoned gym

Area: Gym · Core

El gimnasio abandonado

THE LEGEND

A gym that closed years ago, with its machines still inside. Nobody reused them, and the mall never removed them.

GAME MECHANIC

Exploration space with physics props: machines and weights can be pushed to block doors, climb, or reach items. A good location for an early puzzle.

9. The secret gray corridors

Area: Service corridors · Core

Los pasillos grises

THE LEGEND

Workers describe narrow, gray, dimly lit, silent passages that lead faster to other offices, to offices the public can't reach, and to abandoned parts of the mall.

GAME MECHANIC

The hidden network between public areas. Used for shortcuts, stealth routes, and access to locked zones; sections open up as the player finds keys and access cards. The safest place to move, but also the most claustrophobic.

10. The offices with swimming pools

Area: Upper-floor offices · Later

Las piscinas de la casa de apuestas

THE LEGEND

An upper-floor office of a betting company once had swimming pools. The company was shut down after a criminal case, and the offices were left behind.

GAME MECHANIC

Set piece: an empty, stained pool inside an abandoned office. The player climbs down into the pool to reach the drain area and solve a puzzle.

NOTES

Use a fictional company name.

11. The TV station offices

Area: TV station offices · Later

Las oficinas del canal de TV

THE LEGEND

A well-loved host who had died was said to arrive at the station's offices to pick up some belongings. The guard let him in, but the cameras showed no one, and his signature was in the visitor log. Staff also reported lights turning on and off and things falling.

GAME MECHANIC

Flickering lights and falling objects throughout the area. Discovery moment: the guard's visitor logbook, whose last entry is signed by a man who died days earlier, while the security footage shows an empty hallway.

NOTES

Use a fictional host and station.

Threats

12. The shadow on the cameras

Area: Security room, parking garage · Core

La sombra de las cámaras

THE LEGEND

In a 2012 security-camera video, a guard watches his partner patrol the parking area. A dark shadow appears and moves toward him; he is told over the radio to turn around, and the shadow vanishes as he does.

GAME MECHANIC

A security room with monitors the player can use to scout other areas. Sometimes a dark shape appears on a feed and approaches a figure while a radio voice warns them to look behind. Later, it appears on the feed of the room the player is standing in.

13. The girl in white

Area: Bathrooms, elevators · Core

La niña de blanco

THE LEGEND

Staff and visitors report seeing a little girl dressed in white wandering the mall late at night, especially near the bathrooms and elevators.

GAME MECHANIC

Short, sparing apparitions: in elevator mirrors, at the end of bathroom corridors, as the doors close. She never chases; her appearances warn that something worse is near and cause a small sanity hit.

14. The watchers

Area: Food court, hallways, atriums · Core

Los observadores

THE LEGEND

The same group of people is seen wandering the mall all day without buying anything. They sit and stare into the distance and try to start conversations with people who are alone. Some think they are undercover security; others, a cult looking for recruits.

GAME MECHANIC

Figures that never attack. They are a little closer each time the player looks back, and they drain sanity while they watch. Looking directly at them freezes them; looking away lets them move.

NOTES

The game's most original threat, because they look completely ordinary.

Lore and items

15. The origin of the mall

Area: Notes throughout · Core

El origen: cafetal, constructor y cuerpos

THE LEGEND

The land was a coffee plantation bought from a foreign family. Construction supposedly began without permits, a worker reportedly died during construction, and rumors say bodies lie beneath the foundations.

GAME MECHANIC

The backstory, revealed gradually through invented newspaper clippings, construction documents, and notes, as in Amnesia. The final revelation explains why the mall “woke up.”

16. The weapons in the ceiling

Area: Fifth floor · Later

Las armas del quinto piso

THE LEGEND

During renovations, construction workers found an assault rifle, magazines, and a smoke grenade hidden between the drywall panels of the fifth floor. Police blocked the stairs and ramps while they investigated.

GAME MECHANIC

Hidden compartments: some ceiling and wall panels throughout the mall can be pushed open to find items and notes. On the fifth floor, the player finds a cache like the one in the legend as a lore discovery, not a weapon pickup, since the game has no combat.

17. The laughing-drug photo

Area: Any shop · Later

La droga de la risa

THE LEGEND

Some shops supposedly showed customers a photo laced with a substance that made them briefly lose awareness, so their belongings could be taken.

GAME MECHANIC

A photograph the player can pick up and examine. Looking at it too long triggers hallucinations: the room changes and fake threats appear. It could also be a deliberate tool to reveal hidden things the mall is concealing.